

About Validation Object Standard

Establishing What Is Being Validated Before Validation Begins

Validation cannot begin with a method.

It cannot begin with evidence.

It cannot begin with a conclusion.

It must begin with the object.

Validation Object Standard (VOBS) is the foundational Parent Standard of **VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture** governing how a subject of validation becomes a formally established, identifiable, bounded, versioned, relationally situated, and validation-ready object.

VOBS addresses one foundational question:

What exactly is being validated?

Why Validation Object Standard Exists

Validation conclusions are meaningful only when they can be connected to the exact object that was examined.

An AI model may change.

A dataset may be updated.

A system may operate under a different configuration.

A claim may be modified.

A process may depend on external components.

A decision may relate to a specific operational state.

Without a governed Validation Object, a statement that something has been "validated" may therefore be incomplete or misleading.

VOBS establishes the methodological foundation required to determine precisely **what a validation result applies to**.

The Object Before the Validation

Before validation scope can be established, the object must be known.

Before validation criteria can be defined, the object must be bounded.

Before a validation method can be selected, the relevant version or state must be identifiable.

Before evidence can be evaluated, it must be possible to determine which object that evidence supports.

Before a validation determination can be issued, the exact object to which the determination applies must remain traceable.

VOBS establishes this foundation.

The governing sequence begins:

Candidate Subject → Object Identification → Object Boundary → Object Version → Object Relationships → Object Fitness → Validation Readiness → Governed Validation Object

Only then should the object proceed into the wider VALIDOS® validation governance lifecycle.

What Is a Validation Object?

A Validation Object is the formally established subject to which validation governance applies.

It may be:

- a claim,
- information,
- an AI-generated output,
- a decision,
- a prediction,
- a simulation,
- a dataset,
- an algorithm,
- a model,
- an AI system,
- an autonomous system,
- a process,
- an operational state,
- a methodology,
- a policy,
- a document,
- a control,
- a digital asset,
- a digital identity,
- a physical object,
- an infrastructure component,
- or another subject requiring formal validation.

VOBS does not require all Validation Objects to be validated in the same way.

It requires every Validation Object to be sufficiently established

before its validity is assessed.

Identity, Boundary, Version, Relationship, and Fitness

VOBS approaches the Validation Object through five fundamental governance dimensions.

Identification establishes which object is being validated.

Boundary establishes what belongs to the object and what remains outside it.

Version establishes which state, configuration, release, or temporal representation is subject to validation.

Relationship establishes the dependencies and connections capable of materially affecting the object.

Fitness determines whether the object is sufficiently defined and examinable to proceed into governed validation.

Together, these dimensions transform an undefined candidate subject into a validation-ready governed object.

Validation Readiness Is Not Validity

One of the most important distinctions established by VOBS is the separation between **validation readiness** and **validity**.

An object that cannot yet be reliably identified, bounded, versioned, or examined should not automatically be classified as invalid.

Instead, it may be:

Validation Not Ready

This distinction prevents methodological uncertainty about the object from being incorrectly transformed into a conclusion about the object's validity.

VOBS governs readiness.

Subsequent VALIDOS® standards govern the process through which validity is ultimately determined.

Validation Must Follow the Object

A validation result applies to the object that was actually validated.

If that object materially changes, the original validation cannot automatically be assumed to remain applicable.

Changes to:

- identity,
- boundaries,
- composition,
- configuration,
- version,
- dependencies,
- operational state,
- or material relationships

may affect the applicability of an existing validation determination.

VOBS therefore creates the persistent object reference needed to connect validation results to the precise object examined and to identify when change may require revalidation.

Governance Rather Than Technical Testing

VOBS does not prescribe laboratory procedures, software testing methods, model benchmarks, statistical tests, verification technologies, or implementation-specific validation techniques.

Those mechanisms may be used within a validation process.

VOBS governs something more foundational:

the conditions under which the subject of those activities can be recognized as a properly established Validation Object.

This distinction allows VOBS to remain technology-neutral and applicable across different domains, systems, methodologies, and future technologies.

Position Within VALIDOS®

Validation Object Standard is the first Parent Standard of **VALIDOS®**
— **Validation Governance Architecture.**

It establishes the foundation for the complete validation governance lifecycle:

**Validation Object → Validation Purpose & Scope → Validation Criteria
→ Validation Method → Validation Evidence Fitness → Validation
Source Reliability → Validation Execution → Validation Determination
→ Validation State → Validation Reliance & Revalidation**

VOBS answers the first question.

What exactly are we validating?

The next VALIDOS® governance spaces determine why it is being validated, against which criteria, by which methodology, using which evidence and sources, how validation is executed, what determination follows, which state should be assigned, and whether reliance remains justified.

Relationship to Other OOF® Architectures

VOBS operates alongside complementary OOF® governance architectures.

OBIDENTITY® may establish identity, origin, ownership, provenance, authority, and continuity.

INTEGROS® may establish relevant integrity conditions and integrity states.

ORA™ may establish operational reality and operational-state information.

GOA™ may establish governance authority, scope, boundaries, and delegation.

AGA™ may establish accountability and responsibility relationships.

RIS™ may provide relevant risk information.

VOBS does not reproduce these governance responsibilities.

It uses relevant governed information where necessary to establish the precise object upon which validation governance will operate.

Why It Matters

As AI systems, autonomous systems, digital assets, models, datasets, simulations, and operational environments become increasingly dynamic, the question **"What was actually validated?"** becomes increasingly important.

A validation associated with the wrong version may be misleading.

A validation applied beyond its original boundary may create false confidence.

A validation detached from material dependencies may overlook important conditions.

A validation applied to a materially changed object may no longer be reliable.

VOBS provides the governance foundation needed to prevent these failures.

Foundational Principle

A validation cannot be more precise than the object to which it applies.

Canonical Closing Statement

Validation Object Standard establishes the foundational object-governance layer of VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture. By ensuring that every subject of validation is identifiable, bounded, versioned, relationally situated, and validation-ready before formal validation proceeds, VOBS creates the stable methodological reference required to connect validation determinations to the exact objects they govern throughout the complete validation lifecycle.

Parent Resources

[→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index](#)

Related Documents

[→ Validation Object Standard](#)

[→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer](#)

OOF® MIP® Protection Notice

OOF® · Protected under MIP® — Methodological Intellectual Property

Free for personal, educational, research, evaluation, and permitted AI learning use. Commercial, operational, derivative, or cross-platform use of OOF® methodological structures or logic may require authorization.

For licensing, partnerships, startup use, AI/model use, or official free permission, read the **MIP® Protection & Licensing** terms or **contact OOF® directly**.

Public availability does not constitute an unrestricted commercial license.

Active Protection & Compatibility Detection applies.

Canonical Source

<https://originopenfoundation.org/>